Etienne Boulter

Nice, France | thebrickalista.github.io | 0000-0001-6597-9086 | Google Scholar | TheBrickalista

Experience

Institute for Research on Cancer and Aging of Nice (IRCAN), Inserm U1081, CNRS UMR 7284, Université Côte d'Azur, Inserm Research Scientist (CRCN, tenured) — Nice, France — 2014 – present — 12 years

- Mechanobiology, integrin mechanotransduction and nuclear mechanosensing, in Chloé Féral's team.
- Development of open-source scientific instruments and software.

Inserm AVENIR U634, Skin Biology and Pathophysiology, University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis, Postdoctoral Researcher, laboratory of Dr Chloé Féral — Nice, France — 2009 – 2014 — 5 years

Department of Cell and Developmental Biology, Lineberger Comprehensive Cancer Center, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Postdoctoral Researcher, laboratory of Prof. Keith Burridge — Chapel Hill, NC, USA — 2006 – 2009 — 3 years

Institute of Signaling, Developmental Biology and Cancer (CNRS UMR 6543), University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis, PhD Student, laboratory of Dr Ellen Van Obberghen-Schilling — Nice, France — 2000 – 2005 — 5 years

Education

PhD — **University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis**, Cell Biology — Nice, France — 2001 – 2005

- Highest honours (Mention Très Honorable avec Félicitations du Jury).
- CNRS UMR 6543, group of Dr Ellen Van Obberghen-Schilling.

MSc (DEA) — **University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis**, Cell Biology and Physiology — Nice, France — 2000 – 2001

BSc (Maîtrise) — **University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis**, Biochemistry — Nice, France — 1999 – 2000

Awards

Emergence funding — 2025
Canceropôle PACA

Prix Var – Dr Joseph Amalric — 2013
Ligue contre le Cancer, Comité du Var

Marie Curie International Reintegration Grant (FP7, 2012–2015) — 2012
European Commission

Senior postdoctoral fellowship (24 months) — 2012
Ligue Nationale Contre le Cancer

Postdoctoral fellowship (24 months, 2010–2011) — 2010
City of Nice

Postdoctoral Fellowship (24 months, 2008–2010) — 2008
American Heart Association

Postdoctoral fellowship (12 months) 2006
Fondation pour la Recherche Médicale (FRM)

End-of-PhD fellowship (12 months, 2004–2005) 2004
Fondation ARC

PhD fellowship (36 months, 2001–2004) 2001
French Ministry of Research (MENRT)

Selected Talks

2024: Mechanobiology across Scales, Nice, France (short talk)

2015: Integrated Mechano-chemical Signals in Invasion, Saint-Paul, France (short talk)

2011: Gordon Research Conference, Fibronectin, Integrin and Related Molecules, Il Ciocco, Italy (short talk)

2010: Invited seminar, Sanquin Research Institute, Amsterdam, The Netherlands

2009: ASCB Annual Meeting (short talk selected from abstracts, presented by R. Garcia-Mata)

2009: Jacques Monod Conference on Small GTPases, Aussois, France (short talk)

2005: CNRS GDR 2823 meeting on Rho GTPases and RhoGEFs, Montpellier, France (short talk)

2005: Adhesion Meeting 2005, Munich, Germany (short talk)

2003: Invited seminar, Centre de Recherche de l'Hôtel-Dieu de Québec, Québec, Canada

Peer Review

- Reviewer for Journal of Cell Science, Nature Communications, Scientific Reports, PLOS ONE, Vascular Biology, JoVE, BBRC, British Journal of Cancer, Cell Adhesion & Migration, Trends in Biotechnology, Oncogene and STAR Protocols.

Institutional Service

2018–2023: Researchers' representative, IRCAN laboratory council

2018–2023: Organiser of the IRCAN internal seminar series

2012–2014: Non-permanent staff representative, IRCAN laboratory council

Supervision

2025: 1st-year engineering student, Polytech Nice

2020: 2nd-year engineering student, AgroParisTech

2018: 1st-year engineering student, Polytech Nice

2016: 1st-year engineering student, Polytech Nice

2014: 1st-year engineering student, Polytech Nice

2008–2009: Undergraduate student, UNC Chapel Hill

2004: Maîtrise student in Biochemistry, University of Nice Sophia-Antipolis

Outreach and Media

- "LEGO® bricks are making science more accessible", MIT Technology Review (2024)
- "Des chercheurs utilisent des briques Lego pour reproduire les mécanismes des cellules", RTBF
- "Créer des outils de recherche : un jeu d'enfant", L'Humanité Dimanche (2020)
- "La mécanotransduction des tumeurs, une nouvelle approche contre le cancer", Sciences et Avenir (2013)
- Cordées de la réussite programme, outreach to secondary school students (2023, 2024)

Publication Record

- 22 peer-reviewed articles, reviews and book chapters: see the full list at thebrickalista.github.io/publications.

Outside the Lab

- LEGO® building, which led to my open-hardware instruments
- Trail running
- Volunteer team manager, youth touch rugby (U12/U14)